Syed Aakhib

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SUMMARY

Lead Engineer with **6+ years** in payment gateways and enterprise integrations, leading a **team of 5** across pre-sales, solutioning, RFP responses, and implementation. Technical owner of an **INR 600 Cr annual** enterprise portfolio spanning **60+ enterprise merchants** , discovery to go-live and adoption; cut merchant onboarding time by **25% (24 to 18 days)** . Owned merchant **checkout product decisions** and **contributed to roadmap planning** with product and engineering, cutting tickets from **3-4 to 1-2 per merchant** post-launch. Skilled in **REST APIs, SDKs** , integration automation, and AI-assisted tools.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Engineer, Enterprise Integrations/Solutions | PhonePe, Bangalore | Sep 2025 - Present

- Primary technical owner of an **INR 600 Cr annual** enterprise portfolio, leading integrations end to end from discovery to go-live.
- Managing a **team of 5 people** for **pre-sales, custom solutioning and implementation** , and **AI automation** for the merchant and internal efficiency.
- Owned merchant **checkout product decisions** - payment-mode switching, configurable checkout expiration, customized layout - with product and engineering teams; tickets dropped from **3-4 to 1-2 per merchant** post-launch.
- Cut Mean Time to Integrate (MTTI) by **25% (24 to 18 days)** for enterprise merchant onboarding with **100% stable** post-launch performance.
- Automated merchant **onboarding processes** and introduced an **end-to-end self-serve journey** for enterprise merchants, with **AI** built into the flow.
- Eliminated **30+ manual processes** by building **AI-assisted automation** pipelines and real-time observability dashboards.
- Delivered integrations for **60+ enterprise merchants** across OTT, travel, e-commerce, quick commerce, food delivery, gaming, education, insurance, utilities, and BFSI, resolving delivery blockers early with product and sales teams.
- Turned enterprise business requirements into scalable **API and SDK integration blueprints** through technical discovery workshops.
- Drove API documentation and platform improvements with core engineering using merchant feedback and integration metrics.
- Hands-on experience using **AI tools** such as **Claude, Codex, ChatGPT** , or similar platforms to build solutions, prototypes, code, workflows, or other technical artifacts.

Senior Engineer, Integrations | Pine Labs, Bangalore | Jun 2024 - Sep 2025

- Integrated **Plural and Q-fix** via **APIs, SDKs, and plugins** for high-GTV merchant platforms processing **INR 300-400 Cr/month** .
- Streamlined merchant onboarding and payment processing through direct and third-party integrations with **Juspay, Razorpay, and Cashfree** .
- Cut integration time from **45 days to 15 days** with integration SOPs and JIRA-based onboarding checklists.
- Improved developer onboarding by **30%** while leading back-end **SDK and plugin development** , technical resources, and walkthrough videos.

Product Engineer | Simpl, Bangalore | Jul 2023 - Jun 2024

- Integrated **PayLater, Pay After Delivery, and Pay-in-3** with merchant platforms, direct and via Juspay, supporting **INR 100-150 Cr** monthly GTV.
- Designed **REST APIs, API contracts** , request/response structures, and error handling; debugged transactions with Loggly and AWS OpenSearch.
- Built core functionality in **JavaScript and React.js** ; shipped a searchable documentation portal with Markdown, Swagger, and Poetry.

Solutions Engineer | Razorpay, Bangalore | Mar 2022 - Jul 2023

- Developed **JavaScript checkout solutions** and plugins for **WooCommerce, Shopify, Magento, and WordPress** .
- Integrated and debugged **REST APIs and SDKs (Python, Java, PHP)** for web and mobile applications, including Android and iOS.
- Connected merchant platforms with banks; ran **integration audits, code reviews, and risk analysis** .

Associate Engineer (Internship) | Concentrix India, Bangalore | Jul 2020 - Nov 2021

- Analyzed error reports and logs, audited Google Play Store apps, and built workarounds for performance, security, and payment issues.

EDUCATION

B.Tech in Mechanical Engineering | Dayananda Sagar University, Bangalore | 2020

SKILLS

Leadership and Delivery: Engineering management, technical discovery, solution architecture, stakeholder management, cross-functional delivery, product decisions and roadmap planning

APIs and Integrations: REST APIs, API development, SDKs (incl. Android SDK), API contracts, Swagger, payment gateways, payment systems, merchant onboarding, integration auditing, plugin development

AI: RAG, LLMs, Gems, Copilot, Claude, Codex, ChatGPT, AI-assisted automation and reporting

Frontend: JavaScript, React.js, HTML, CSS

Backend: Python, Java, PHP, SQL

Payments Platforms: Juspay, Razorpay, Cashfree, Pine Labs (Plural, Q-fix), PayLater

E-commerce and Mobile: Shopify, WooCommerce, Magento, WordPress, Android, iOS

Tools: JIRA, Postman, Loggly, AWS OpenSearch, Markdown, Poetry, observability dashboards, process automation